

COLOSSAL SERPENT

TITANOBOA

The gigantic *Titanoboa* was one of the largest and heaviest snakes to have ever lived. Evolving around 6 million years after the extinction event that ended the Cretaceous Period, this relative of modern-day boa constrictors was probably a top predator in its time. Fossils of *Titanoboa* were first discovered in a coal mine in Colombia in 2009, and paleontologists have only found a few bones of this snake. The fossils tell us that *Titanoboa* had a large, bulky body. Like modern-day snakes, it probably had flexible jaws that helped it swallow large prey whole.

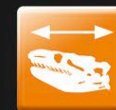
**BIGGEST
SNAKE**

Titanoboa probably moved slowly, using its belly muscles to move in wavelike motions.

STATS AND FACTS

By comparing *Titanoboa*'s fossils to the bones of modern snakes, scientists estimate that it may have weighed 2,502 lb (1,135 kg)—more than 10 times as much as most modern anacondas and around four times as much as most modern zebras.

SKULL SIZE



The skull of *Titanoboa* was 16 in (40 cm) long—about three times the length of a modern reticulated python's skull.

WIDTH



The thickest parts of *Titanoboa*'s body were as wide as 3 ft (1 m), which is the average height of an 8-year-old child.

